Yoshiki Wiskamp

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Placement Officer: Professor Matthias Doepke · m.doepke@lse.ac.uk
Placement Support: Emma Taverner · econ.facultysupport@lse.ac.uk

DOCTORAL STUDIES

London School of Economics and Political Science 2021–2027
PhD in Economics. MRes completed in 2023 with Distinction.

REFERENCES

Gharad Bryan
London School of Economics
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Robin Burgess
London School of Economics
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Daniel Sturm
London School of Economics
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Oriana Bandiera
London School of Economics
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PRIOR EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science 2020–2021
MSc in Economics. *Distinction*.

Goethe University Frankfurt 2016–2020
BSc in Economics and Business Administration. *Final grade: 1.0*

University of Tokyo 2018/19
Visiting Student.

RESEARCH FIELDS

Urban Economics, Environmental Economics (primary)
Development Economics, Economic History (secondary)

JOB MARKET PAPER

Channeling Density? Sewers and the Growth of 19th-Century Paris

with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez

Abstract: Urban density promises agglomeration benefits but also exacerbates pollution and disease transmission. Sanitation infrastructure may therefore be essential for cities to sustain dense concentrations of economic activity. To study how sanitation investments shape urban development, we compile a novel address-level dataset covering the construction of the Parisian sewer network in the nineteenth century. Exploiting within-neighbourhood variation in the timing of sewer connections in an event-study design, we find that connecting a parcel to the sewer network increases both population and firm counts. Sewer connections in nearby locations generate additional increases, with larger spillovers in more densely populated areas. We incorporate these findings into a quantitative urban model and estimate that sewer access increases residential amenity values by 2.5% and firm productivity by 5% in connected locations. The analysis further reveals that, in unsewered areas, the marginal effect of additional people on others' utility turns negative as neighbourhoods densify and pollution costs intensify. Sewers eliminate this downturn. Counterfactuals indicate that sewerage investments account for 30% of Paris' population growth in the second half of the nineteenth century. One-quarter of this effect operates through reductions in negative sanitation externalities, while the remainder reflects the private benefits of sewer access. These findings highlight how addressing waste pollution can lower the costs of proximity and sustain urban growth.

WORKING PAPER

Trading Trash on Tricycles

with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez

Best Student Paper at the 2026 Urban Economics Association European Meeting

Abstract: Developing megacities face severe congestion externalities but lack the fiscal and enforcement capacity for textbook regulation. In its absence, unregulated private provision emerges across services like waste, sanitation, water, and transport. We ask whether limited, feasible regulation can leverage these informal markets to deliver public services at scale, focusing on trash collection in

Accra, Ghana. Using novel data, we document an imperfect but functioning market: households pay informal tricycle collectors for door-to-door service, yet prices remain too high for universal access, and final disposal occurs largely at illegal dumpsites. We identify a single feasible lever—subsidies for formal, environmentally controlled disposal—and evaluate it using a new structural model of urban waste collection and disposal. To estimate the model, we combine survey experiments eliciting household demand, a custom app recording transactions and tricycle routes, and a field experiment randomising dumping fees. A modest subsidy captures roughly 80% of the first-best welfare gain, substantially reducing environmental damages and generating larger gains at lower cost than planned infrastructure expansion. Limited price-based regulation can align informal private initiative with social objectives even where state capacity is weak.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Golden Traps? Self-Reinforcing Dynamics of Artisanal Mining

with Sreevidya Ayyar and Hemawathy Balarama

Abstract: Transient shocks, such as weather and global commodity price fluctuations, increasingly drive land-use transitions in developing economies. Where land-use decisions generate externalities, small deviations from the status quo can trigger self-reinforcing dynamics that lead to large and potentially irreversible transitions between equilibria. To what extent are land-use changes driven by individual, poverty-driven decisions versus spatial externalities and strategic complementarities? And how can policy interventions facilitate coordination towards the socially optimal use of land? This project examines these questions in the context of the shift from agriculture to illegal artisanal mining, which employs 45 million households in Sub-Saharan Africa and has led to devastating land degradation, water pollution, and irreversible loss of forests. We assemble a novel dataset combining remote-sensing data and administrative records to document the spatial and temporal spread of mining activity and its determinants in Ghana. Building on these data, we will estimate a structural model of land-use decisions to quantify how environmental externalities, market forces, and community characteristics shape the transition from agriculture to mining. We will use the model to identify how and when policy interventions can align land-use decisions with socially optimal outcomes, preventing costly and potentially irreversible land degradation.

A Century of Mis(sed)-Treatment: Toxic Waters and Unequal Urban Development

with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez

Abstract: Over 80% of the world's wastewater is discharged into the environment untreated. Rivers, lakes and coastlines remain polluted for decades. As cities expand, these long-contaminated areas are eventually absorbed by urban growth. We study the long-run consequences of the Seine's pollution for the development of the Parisian suburbs. Sewage was discharged untreated into the Seine downstream of the city from the 1860s onwards. These discharges caused a sharp deterioration in water quality around the outfall, documented in 1874 in one of the first water quality analyses in history. Using newly digitised nineteenth-century cadastral records, we show that the onset of discharges led to the emergence of discontinuities in land values and land use around the discharge point. Wastewater treatment was introduced only in the 1980s, nearly a century later. Although water quality around the outfall has since recovered, the effects of historical pollution on urban development persist today, with house prices remaining 13% lower downstream of the outfall. Our findings highlight the long-run consequences of water pollution and show how historical pollution can shape disparities in urban development long after environmental conditions have improved.

POLICY WORK

Urban Water and Sanitation Systems: Managing Infrastructure, Institutions and Access

with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez, Mikey Blake, Victoria Delbridge, and Edward Glaeser

IGC Synthesis Paper, 2026

Policy Options for Expanding Urban Water and Sanitation

with Ignacio Banares-Sanchez, Mikey Blake, Victoria Delbridge, and Edward Glaeser

IGC Policy Toolkit, 2026

RESEARCH GRANTS

Structural Transformation and Economic Growth, Research Grant (£15,000) 2026
International Growth Centre, Research Grant (£100,000) 2025
European Space Agency, Network of Resources Sponsorship (€5,000) 2024
International Growth Centre, Research Grant (£30,000) 2024
STICERD LSE, PhD Research Grant (£5,000) 2024
International Growth Centre, Small Project Fund (£20,000) 2023

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Best Student Paper, Urban Economics Association European Meeting 2026
LSE Economics Department Scholarship 2021–2026
German Academic Scholarship Foundation (*Studienstiftung*) 2019–2023
Graduate Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (*DAAD*) 2020–2021
PROMOS Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (*DAAD*) 2018–2019
German National Scholarship, Goethe University Frankfurt 2018

CONFERENCES

European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association, LSE Environment Week, EEE Mini-Conference on Climate Inequalities 2026

Selected presentations by co-author: NBER Summer Institute EEE 2026, BSE Summer Forum Development 2026, CEPR Conference on Urban and Regional Economics 2025

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Intern, Halle Institute for Economic Research 2020
Project: Climate Resilient Economic Development in Vietnam

Research Assistant to Michael Binder, Goethe University Frankfurt 2019–2020
Chair for International Macroeconomics and Macroeconometrics

TEACHING

Online Development Economics Course (IZA/FCDO G^{2}LM|LIC, IGC) 2025–2026

EC307 Development Economics (LSE) 2024–2026
TA for Oriana Bandiera & Robin Burgess · Evaluations: 4.7, 4.8, 4.9 out of 5

EC2A3 Microeconomics II (LSE) 2023–2024
TA for Dimitra Petropoulou · Evaluation: 4.8/5

EC1B3 Macroeconomics I (LSE) 2022–2024
TA for Antonio Mele · Evaluations: 4.9, 4.8 out of 5

EC1A3 Microeconomics I (LSE) 2022–2023
TA for Ronny Razin · Evaluation: 4.8/5

SKILLS

LaTeX, Matlab, Python, QGIS, R, Stata

PERSONAL

Residency: Germany (citizen), Japan (citizen), UK (pre-settled)
Languages: English (fluent), German (native), Japanese (fluent)

November 2026